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Editing with Claude

THE BIG PROBLEMS

PROBLEM 01

TWO WEEKS FROM FILMING TO POSTING

PROBLEM 02

EDITING IS SLOW AND EXPENSIVE

PROBLEM 03

HOURS OF RAW FOOTAGE TO SORT THROUGH

THE OPPORTUNITY

OPPORTUNITY 01

CLAUDE DOES THE BORING 80%

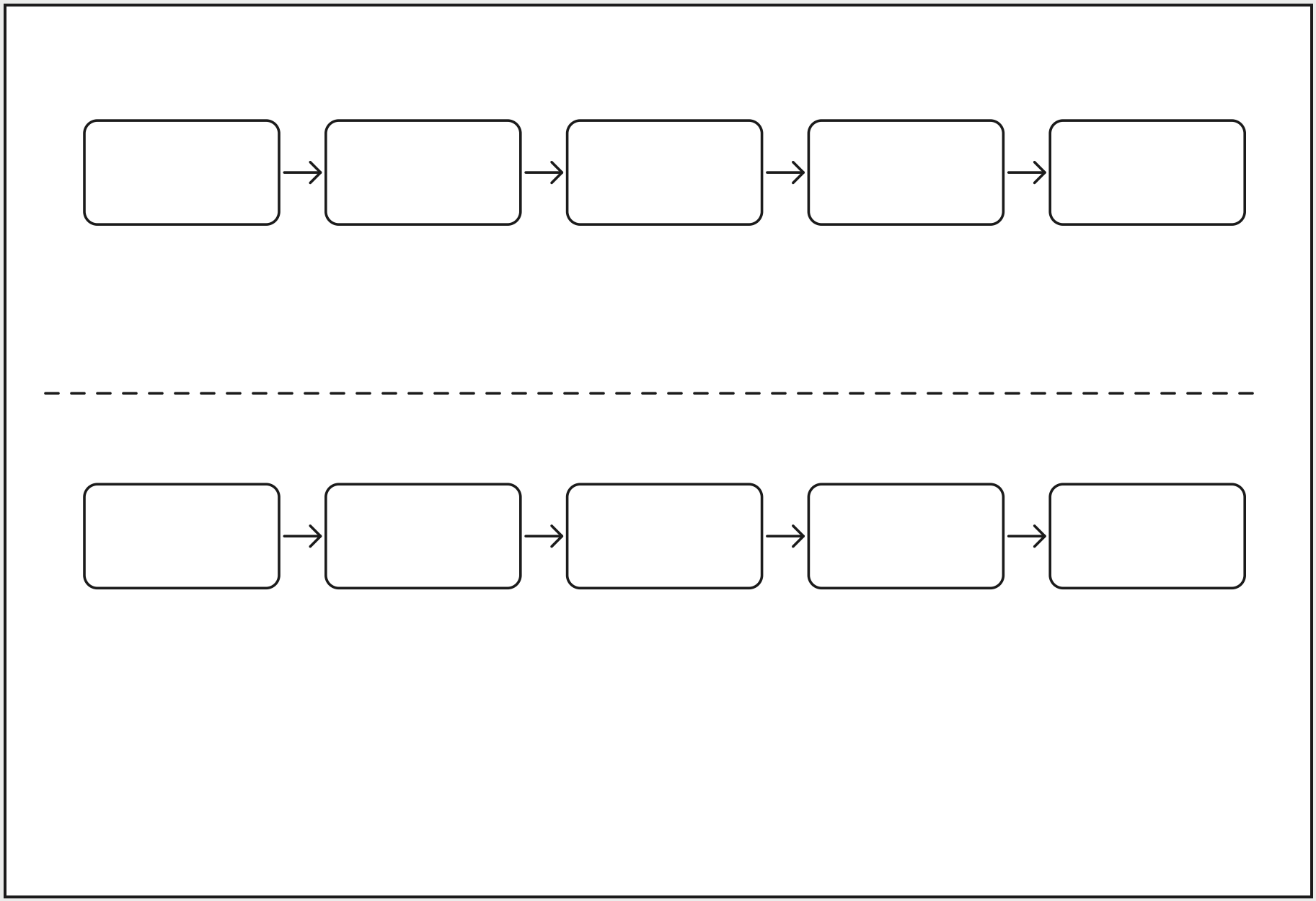
OPPORTUNITY 02

SAME-DAY TURNAROUND

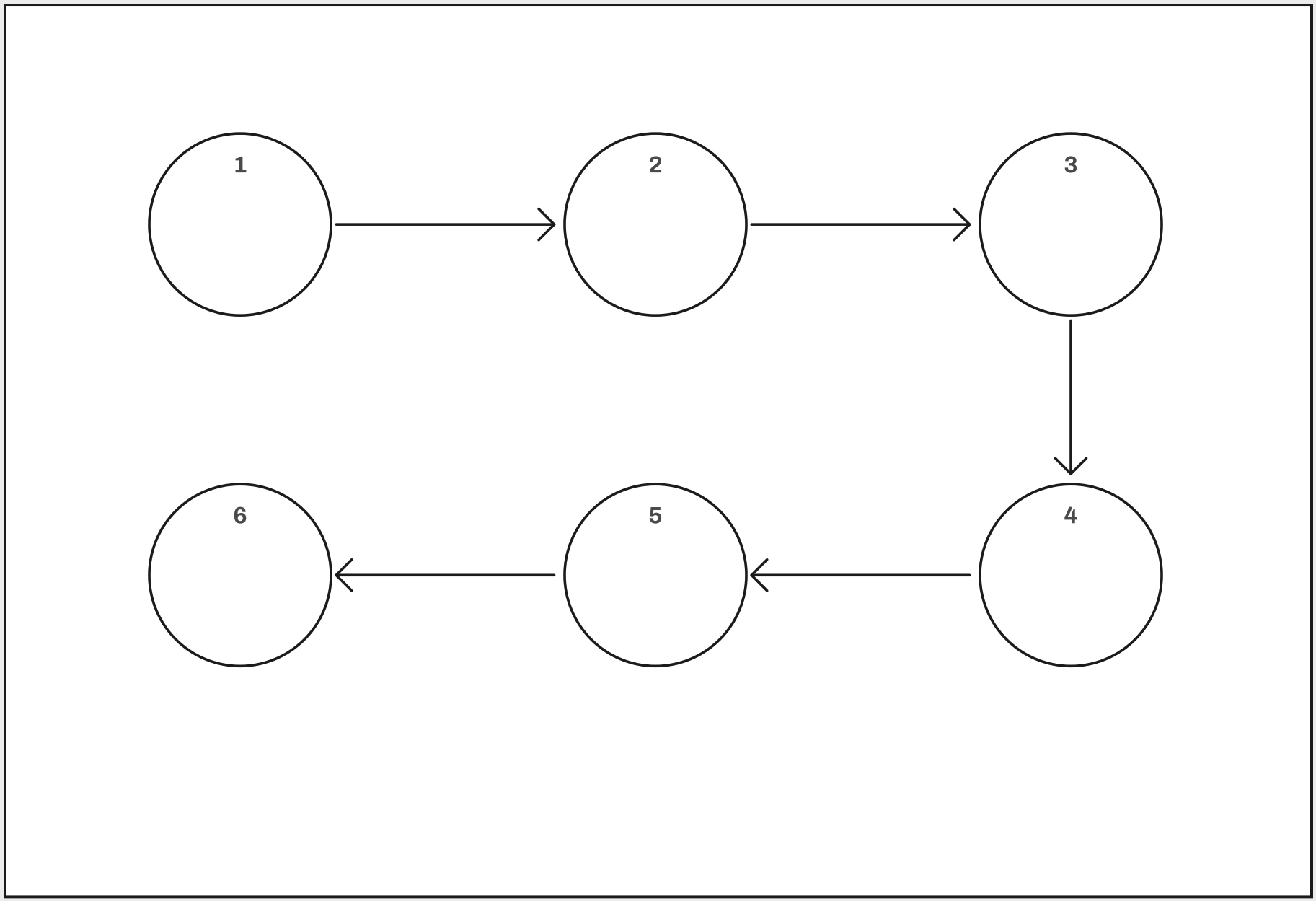
OPPORTUNITY 03

WRITE THE EDIT SPEC ONCE

The Old Way vs The Claude Way



The Claude Edit Pipeline



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What You Need

1. Claude Pro or Max

Use Claude Code (the Code tab in the Claude desktop app). It can work with the files on your computer, which the chat window can't.

2. One folder per shoot

e.g. Content / 2026-11 Shoot / raw
Copy every clip off the card into it. Add your shot list and scripts.

3. Free tools (Claude installs them)

ffmpeg: cuts, resizes and exports video.
Whisper: transcribes speech with word timings.
Just ask Claude to set them up.

4. Your edit spec

Caption style, brand colours, names and terms to spell right, sizes, end card. One page. (Worksheet at the end of this module.)

Optional: animated captions

Ask Claude to build a Remotion project for word-by-word highlighted captions. Reuse it every month.

Optional: final polish

Open Claude's cut in CapCut or Premiere for music and B-roll, or hand it to an editor as a head start.

The Prompts

1. Selects

My raw clips are in [folder]. My shot list and scripts are in shot-list.md.

Install ffmpeg and Whisper if they're not set up. Transcribe every clip with word-level timestamps.

For each video on the shot list, find the best complete take (clean delivery, no restarts) and give me a cut list: file, in time, out time, and why you picked it.

2. Rough cut

Cut each video from the cut list.

Remove pauses longer than 0.4s and any restarted lines. Keep a short beat before the key line.

Export 9:16 (1080x1920) and 4:5 (1080x1350). Pull 3 still frames from each so I can check the framing.

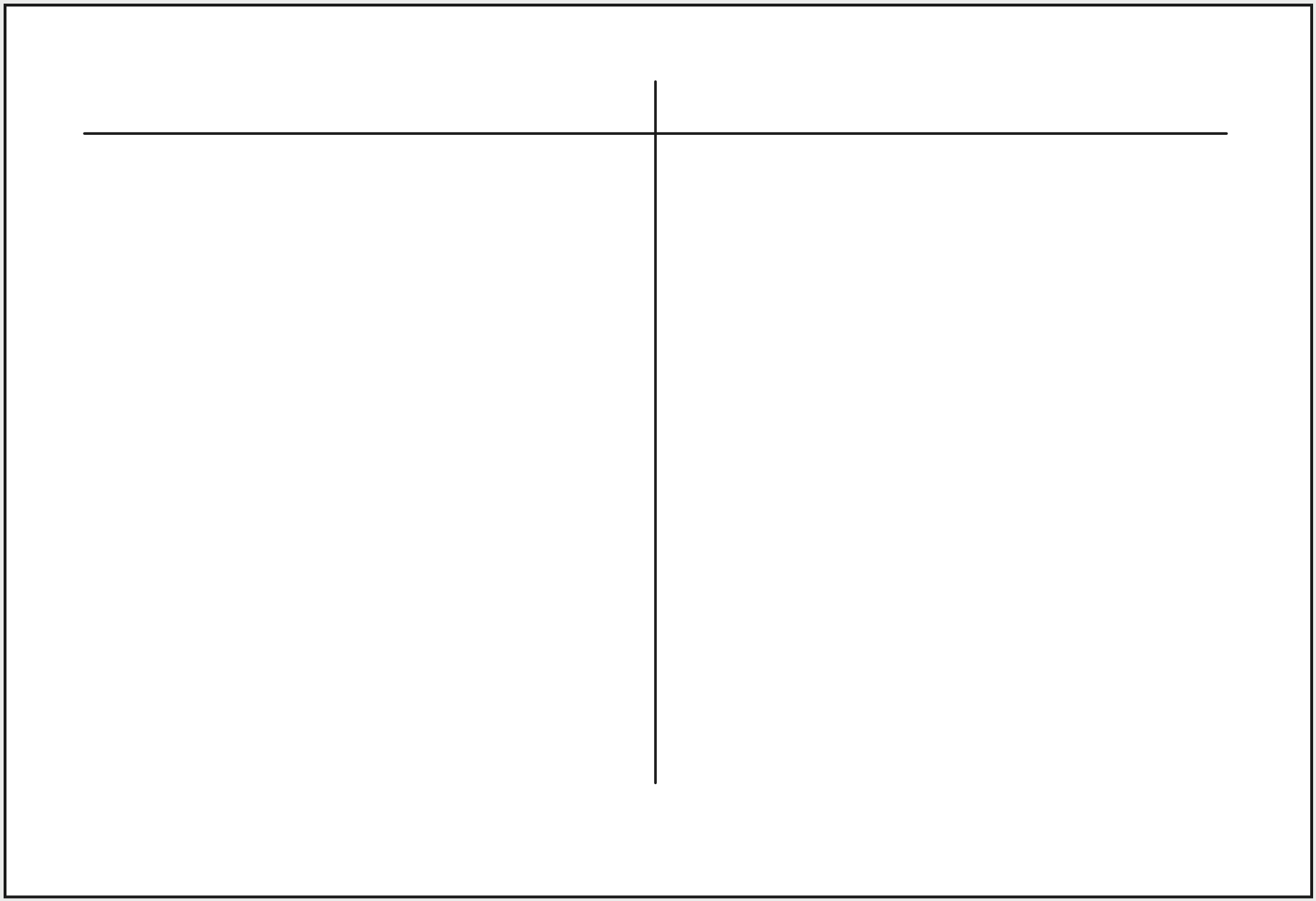
3. Captions + files

Burn in captions using edit-spec.md: bold, 2-4 words at a time, current word highlighted in [colour].

Spell these right: [names, suburbs, legal terms]. Australian spelling ("enquiries").

Name files [Firm]-[##]-[Topic]-[9x16].mp4 and put them in /final.

Claude Does / You Do



CLAUDE DOES THE 80%
THAT'S BORING.
YOU KEEP THE 20% THAT'S TASTE.

Your Edit Spec

10 Minutes

Caption style | Font, size, highlight colour, words per line

Brand | Colours, logo, end card

Spell these right | Names, firm name, suburbs, legal / finance terms

Sizes | Which platforms?

Music | Vibe, or none

Pace | How tight are the cuts?

Never | Things Claude or an editor must never do

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Next...

Takeaways:

Actions:

Communications:

Checklist:

- [ ] Install the Claude desktop app, open Claude Code
- [ ] Make your content folder + copy in the raws
- [ ] Fill in your Edit Spec, save as edit-spec.md
- [ ] Run the 3 prompts on one video first
- [ ] Watch, approve, then batch the rest

Notes

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